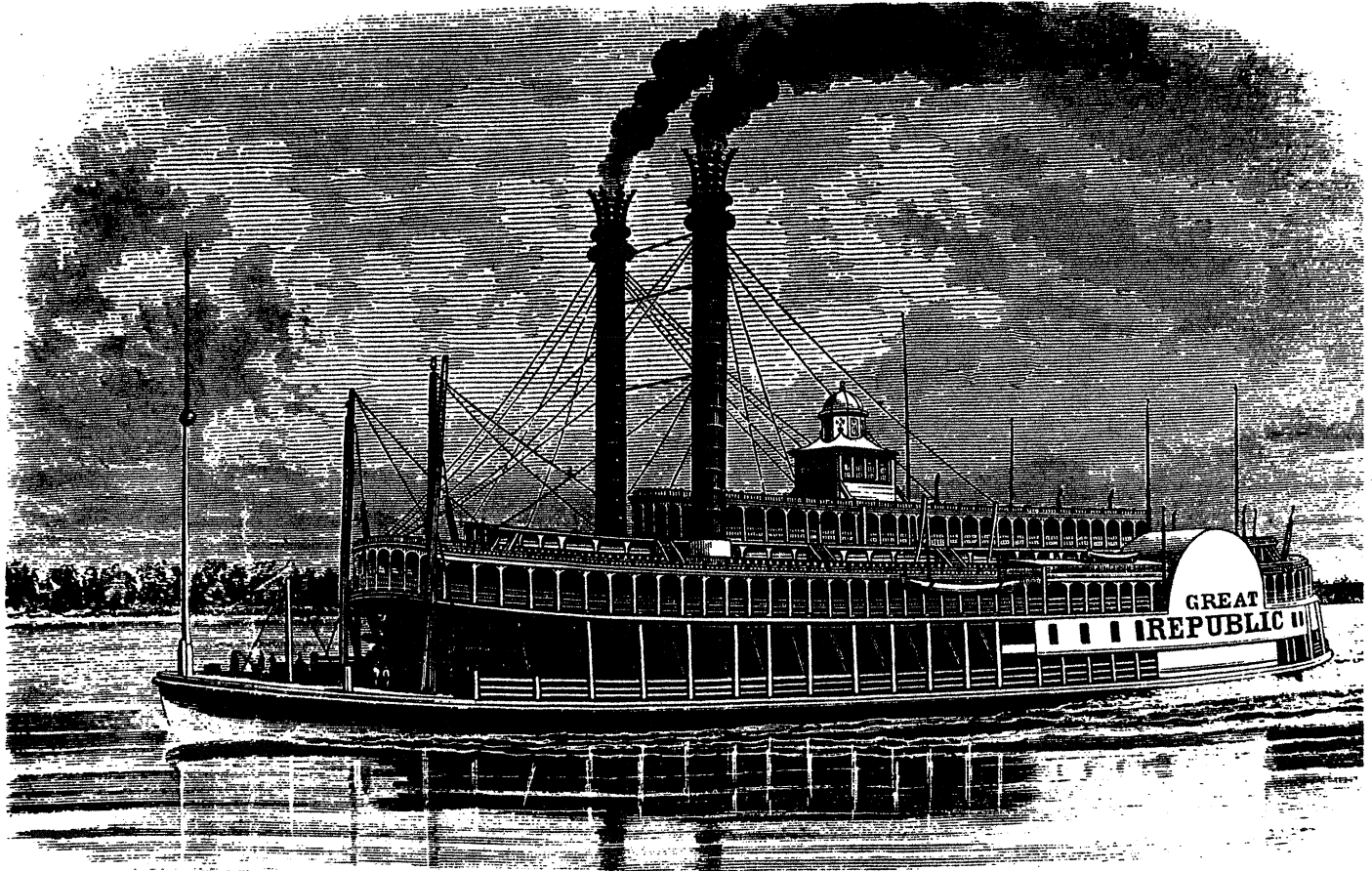




THE GREAT REPUBLIC

A BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF A GREAT BOAT
-DIMENSIONS, POWER AND APPOINTMENTS
Great Throngs Of Visitors Yesterday

THE MOST MAGNIFICENT STEAMER THAT EVER FLOAT-ED, the GREAT REPUBLIC, Capt. William B. Donaldson, leaves this city, Pittsburgh, this day, Saturday, March 16, 1867, at 4 p.m. for Memphis and New Orleans. The Board of Trade did themselves credit by procuring for Capt. Donaldson a grand piano and a splendid suit of colors that will be presented this morning at 10 o'clock. The crowd yesterday to view this splendid specimen of naval architecture was the largest we have ever seen on the landing, the principal portion being ladies.

For months past visitors to the Monongahela wharf have regaled themselves with the view of the grand proportions of the steamer GREAT REPUBLIC which today will take her departure for the South, never to return to this port. Curiosity has been on tip-toe to get a glimpse of the interior of this gigantic steamer whose colossal proportions have been the theme on every tongue interested in boating on the Western waters, and today her principal owner, Capt. William B. Don-

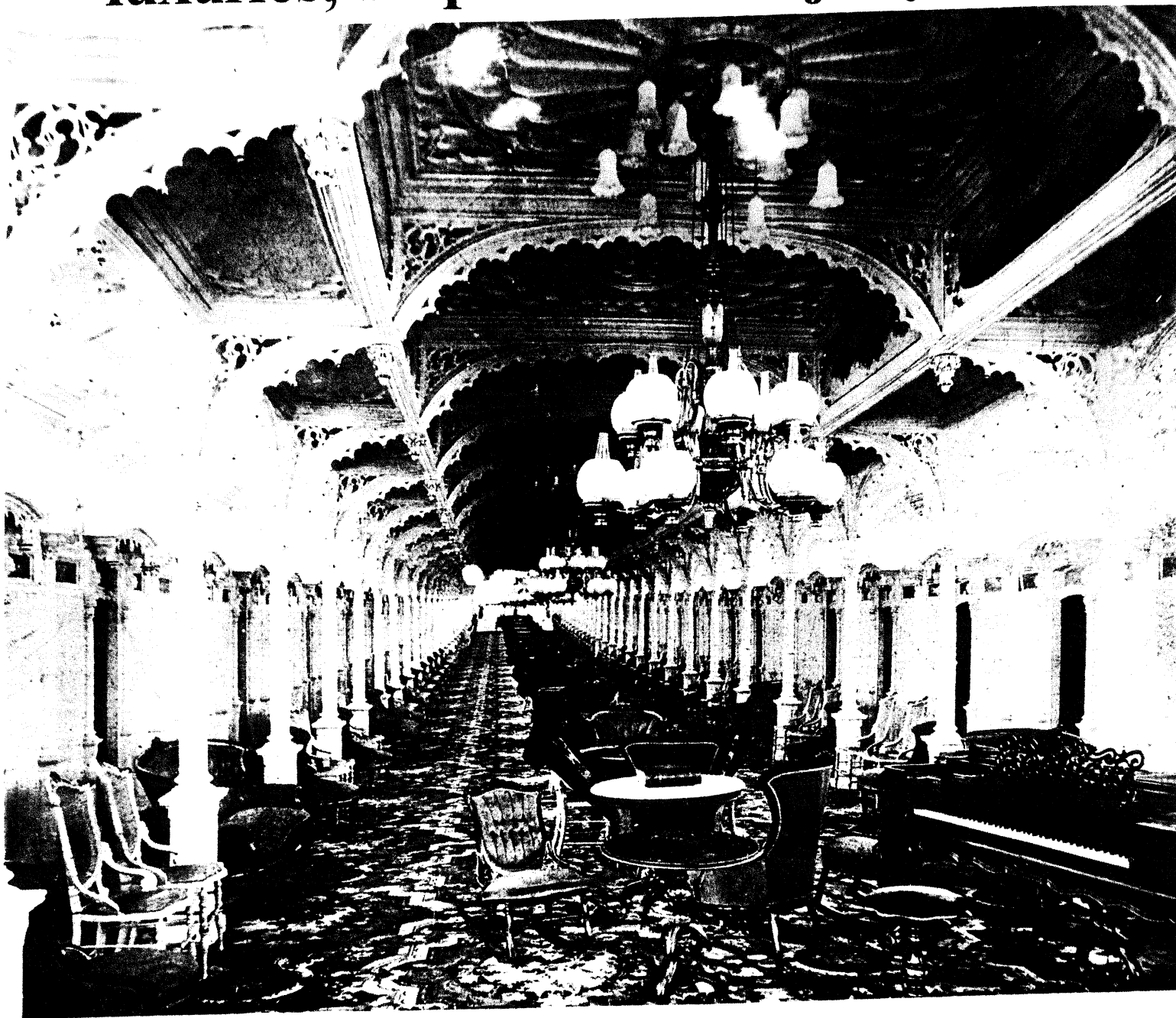
aldson, proposes to throw her cabin and decks open to the public for the inspection of all who may desire to call, and they will not be few. Various descriptions of the GREAT REPUBLIC have been published, and all have failed to give anything like a correct idea of the magnitude of the boat, the elegance of her appointments and the thorough finish of her workmanship. On one point, however, all agree; and that is, for beauty of architectural design, strength and motive power, carrying capacity and thorough workmanship in every detail, her equal is not to be found on Western waters. This may seem strong language, but an unprejudiced inspection of the boat will fully substantiate it. The following description of the boat, the facts and figures being obtained from her builders and officers, will give our readers some idea of her magnificence:

THE HULL

Was built by Messrs. E. & N. Porter at their yard at Shousetown, Pa. and is a remarkable specimen of workmanship, for strength and durability. The dimensions are as follows: Length on deck, 330 feet; width of beam 51 feet; depth of hold, 10 feet; 6 ft. sheer forward and 5½ feet aft; extreme width over all, 95 feet. Her timbers are 4½" x 11", 12 and 13 inches apart; planks 5 inches thick. Height between main and boiler decks,

Continued on Page 6

You are invited to explore the splendors, luxuries, surprises and majesty



Continued from Page 1

17 feet. Main keelson, 12 x 24 inches; bilge keelson, 8 x 16 inches; floor keelson, 6 x 12 inches, five in number on each side; center bulkhead, 3½ inches thick. Beams 9 x 4½ inches; deck 3 inches thick.

The model is faultless, her builders having in view the greatest speed ever attained by a steamer on the Western rivers. Her bow is beautifully modeled, and her cut-water though not so sharp as Damascus steel will cleave the water so clearly and sharply that the elements will be cheated of her approach. "Great expectations" exist as to her speed, and if with the most perfect hull and most perfect machinery ever put in a steam-

The cabin of the GREAT REPUBLIC, photographed at St. Louis by Boehl & Koenig, corner of Fifth and Olive Streets. In the right foreground is the piano presented by the Pittsburgh Board of Trade. This particular view is often reproduced as a classic example of "Steamboat Gothic" interior architecture. The original from which this print is made was an old-time gold-tone, about the same dimensions as above.

boat these expectations are not realized our skilled mechanics will be mistaken for the first time in the history of steamboat building.

THE MOTIVE POWER

Of the GREAT REPUBLIC is to practical minds the most astonishing feature of the boat. She is provided with two of A. Hartup's patented duplex condensing engines. The two smaller cylinders are 22 inches in diameter with 10 feet stroke. The two large cylinders are 56 inches in diameter with 10 feet stroke. The smaller cylinders are supplied directly from the boilers and the large cylinders by the exhaust steam from the smaller ones; consequently all the power derived from the large cylinders is gained without any expense of fuel. The power of these large cylinders is almost twice that of the smaller and therefor gives a savings of about 60 per cent of fuel, which is one of the heaviest expenses of running a steamboat. The inventor claims that with this kind of machinery boats can run on much less pressure of steam than boats with the old style of engines, and consequently are much safer from explosion, this from the fact that they will carry a low pressure of steam on boilers designed to carry a high pressure.

She is provided with seven boilers, each 44 inches in diameter, 28 feet long, with four flues in each, of the very best material and workmanship. Her paddlewheels are 40 feet in diameter, with 18-foot buckets with 30-inch face, and are a model of strength. She has a "Doctor" to supply the boilers; one engine in the bow to work the capstan; one in the stern to work the stern capstan, and one in the mid-ships to work the Robert Lea's patent freight elevator. She has a steam fire engine with 12 hose connections; with 100 feet of hose always attached to each connection, capable of throwing 400 gallons per minute on any part of the boat. The shaft and cranks, which weigh 32 tons each, of wrought iron, are from the forge of Jos. P. Haigh. Her chimneys are 7 feet in diameter, and 73 feet high above the hurricane deck.

THE CABIN

Of the GREAT REPUBLIC which approaches in magnificence the storied palaces of the East, was designed and constructed by Charles Gearing, Esq. The extreme length of the cabin is 270 feet, and is 28'2" wide. It contains 54 staterooms, each eight feet square, and fitted up in an elegant and comfortable manner, having a wardrobe, washstand and toilet stand and bed hung with brocatelle curtains. (Ed. Note: Brocatelle is French, meaning a heavy, figured cloth-like brocade, usually of silk and linen). The promenades on each side of the cabin are 5'6" wide, and between the promenades the cabin is 17 feet in width. These promenades are separated from the cabin by a row of columns on each side, 72 in number. These are united by beautiful arches, perforated and carved. The finish over the doors is canopy which is perforated and carved and supported by columns.

The looking glass in the ladies' cabin is 6'3" in length by 10 feet wide, and is elegantly finished in keeping with the interior arrangements of the cabin.

The office, which is a handsome specimen of architecture, is located in the center of the cabin, forward. It is a circle 15 feet in diameter, elegantly ornamented with perforated carv-

ed facings. All of the ornamental work is of wood whose beauty is heightened with skillful application of azure, white and gold coloring.

The design of the cabin is strictly Gothic and although the work is elaborate it is not overdone.

The furniture of the cabin was made to order, is of modern style and most costly material. The carpet is English velvet, furnished by MacCallum and Bro. of this city and cost \$12.00 per yard--the whole expense for carpeting being \$10,000. Pendant from the hurricane deck are ten elegant chandeliers valued at \$500 each which, when burning, shed a brilliant light over the entire cabin, and serve to give passengers an excellent opportunity to inspect the splendid

OIL PAINTINGS

By our talented townsman, Col. W. C. Wall. These paintings are sixty-six in number and are chiefly transcripts from Nature, but few are copies. Commencing at the front entrance of the cabin, in the semi-circle over the office, there are three summer views on the Conemaugh River near Bolivar (downstream from Johnstown, Pa. -Ed.) sketched by Mr. Wall. Taking them by pairs, one on the right, the other on the left, we have next two Autumn views, then two views on the Susquehanna River sketched from Nature; two Arctic Ocean scenes taken from Dr. Kane's works; two marine views; two waterfalls conceived by the artist; a view on the Susquehanna River near Harrisburg; and another on the Conemaugh, both sketched by Mr. Wall; a view of the Mississippi River near Milliken's Bend (above Vicksburg, -Ed.) and one on the Susquehanna below Harrisburg, also sketched from Nature; a view of Mr. J. M. D. Crossan's place at Hulton Station on the Allegheny River (upper end of Oakmont, Pa. -Ed.), and one of the Ohio River just below the city; two views on the Susquehanna near Millersburg (in Dauphin County, Pa. -Ed.); two fancy river scenes; a view on the Hudson sketched from Nature, and a twilight scene on a bay, copied; a view on the Allegheny just above Sharpsburg, and one on the Ohio near the Pork House (in Brunot's Island -Ed.); views of Lake Jessie (don't know it, -Ed.) and Fort Benton on the Missouri, copied; a scene on the Tombigbee and a marine view; a view on the Connecticut and a lake scene, both copied; a view on the Ohio sketched from Nature, and a fancy river sketch; two views on the Kiskiminetas by Mr. Wall; a marine view, fancy, and a view of the Conemaugh near Blairsville from Nature; Lake Lochinvar and the Isle of Cyprus, copied; two original landscapes; two copies, one of Venice, and the other a scene on the Jersey coast; views on the Ohio and Susquehanna by Mr. Wall; two original Autumn scenes; a view on the Ohio below Manchester (Pa. that is -Ed.) and another on the Conemaugh near Bolivar, both by the artist; two Autumn scenes, originals; two scenes from the Conemaugh; view on the Kiskiminetas and a sketch of Ohio Pyle Falls on Andy Stewart's place on the Youghiogheny River above Connellsville, Pa.; two marine views, one of a lighthouse and the other of an old Jersey prison ship; a morning view on the Susquehanna and an evening view on the same river just below Harrisburg, by the same artist; a sunset scene and "The Lover's Quarrel," both copied; two American winter scenes; and one from Woods Run (just below Pittsburgh, -Ed.) and last of all an evening view on Lake George.

[illegible]

ORIGINAL INSPECTION CERTIFICATE

Issued at Pittsburgh, March 16, 1867 by U.S. Steamboat Inspectors Samuel Walker and George H. Atkinson. The much vaunted "low pressure" GREAT REPUBLIC was allowed to carry 123 psi. which by standards of 1867 was considerable. The handsome "low pressure" side-wheeler RICHMOND which was getting finishing touches at Jeffersonville, Ind. when the GREAT REPUBLIC passed there, carried 35 psi. and was comparable in her capacity and dimensions. George H. Atkinson, the U.S. Boiler Inspector named above, served 40 years or more at Pittsburgh, retiring in 1908; he made his home in Wilkinsburg. The preservation of this original 'office copy' certificate is due to the level head of the late U.S. Inspector Capt. Edward L. Shaw at Pittsburgh. Upon receipt of orders from Washington to destroy all old office records because they were obsolete, Capt. Shaw arranged transfer of them to interested river historians.

The table of the GREAT REPUBLIC will be supplied with richest description of ware. The most attractive will be the silverware, numbering 400 pieces, which was gotten up in a style that reflects great credit upon the well known firm of Mead and Company, Philadelphia. For elegance of workmanship and design this service is unsurpassed. It is made of nickel silver and triple plated and, aside from value, is more elegant and tasteful than if made from solid material. Messrs. Mead & Company have expended much pains in getting up several hundred pieces, as they give their exclusive attention to hotels and steamboats with ware, and desire, doubtless, to extend trade to the West and South.

Among the office furniture may be mentioned two safes which are built in; one a fireproof, and the other for packages. It is sufficient to say they were built by Messrs. Burke & Barnes of this city whose salamanders (articles built to withstand heat, -Ed.) have a world-wide reputation.

THE NURSERY AND TEXAS

The nursery which is immediately beneath the ladies' cabin has fifteen rooms, neatly fitted up and on the same deck are the wash-rooms, ironing rooms, bathrooms, etc.

The texas is 170 feet long by 26 feet wide and has a guard six feet wide all around. It contains ten rooms for the passengers besides accommodations for the entire crew.

CAPACITY

The boat draws but $4\frac{1}{2}$ feet of water, light, and has capacity for 2,500 tons of freight.

OFFICERS

OFFICERS

The GREAT REPUBLIC will be commanded by Capt. W. B. Donaldson, her principal owner, a gentleman and officer well calculated by education and experience for the position. He will be ably assisted by his lieutenants, Capt. Sam Barr, Jr., chief clerk, and by Capt. Charles A. Dravo, Capt. Cal W. Bennett, Jr. and George W. Floyd, who will be associated in the office. This is an admirable association of steamboat clerks--there being none superior to them in Western or Southern waters. The rest of the officers are as follows: Samuel McBride and Samuel Williamson, pilots; William Patterson, first mate; William Mumbar, second mate; John Hartuppee, first engineer; J. W. Starr, second engineer; Stewart Guthrie, carpenter; Samuel W. Morgan, steward; James Simmons, bar-keeper.

BUILDERS AND FURNISHERS

The following is the list of the builders of the boat and those who furnished her outfit, furniture, etc. Hull by E. & N. Porter; machinery by A. Hartupee & Co.; cabin by Charles Gearing, Esq.; boilers, Morrow & Barnhill; painting and glazing, O. R. Boggs & Co.; landscape painting, Col. William C. Wall; gilding, decorations, etc., J. J. Gillespie; bells, brass-work, fittings, etc., A. Fulton & Sons Co.; lines, outfit, etc., Caldwell & Bro.; sheet-iron work, copper, tin work, cook stoves, etc., Fitzsimmons & Morrow; cabin stoves, A. Bradley & Co.; spars, flagstuffs and etc., George W. Coffin; upholstery, Holtzman & Weiderholt; carpets, etc., McCallum & Bro.; blocks and rigging, Phillips & Beechley; wire tiller ropes, Evans, Gilmore & Dallas; glassware, J. B. Lyon & Co.; books and printing, W. S. Hav-

en; hardware, Whitmore, Wolf, Duff & Co.; furniture, J. W. Woodwell & Son; silverware, Mead & Co., Philadelphia; chandeliers, Miskey, Merrill & Factory, Philadelphia; chinaware, E. V. Houg-waut, New York; posters, cards, etc., M. Halstead & Co., Cincinnati; skylights and French plate glass, William Coulter, Cincinnati; barber chairs by John DeKamp, Cincinnati; stained cut glass for doors, etc., A. Jones & Co., New York.

The Board of Trade of Pittsburgh furnished a handsome grand piano valued at \$1,000 and also a handsome and costly set of colors whose dimensions and elegance are in keeping with the character of the boat.

The entire cost of the boat with her appointments will approximate \$350,000.

DEPARTURE TODAY

Owing to the rapid fall of the river Capt. Donaldson has determined to leave with the GREAT REPUBLIC this afternoon for her future field of service. To our southern and western contemporaries we commend her as the beaux ideal of beauty, strength and grandeur, with the further assurance that there is none now floating on southern waters that can compare with her. For elegance combined with safety and comfort the GREAT REPUBLIC outranks any boat now built, and when she is eclipsed in either respect Pittsburgh mechanics will be prepared to build equal if not superior to the best.

Her speed is not yet to be ascertained, but from the construction of her model and from the immense force of her motive power, it is safe to say she will not follow far behind the fleetest on the waters. We wish the GREAT REPUBLIC and her clever and accomplished officers a prosperous career and will anxiously await a report of her first performances.

PIANO AND COLOR PRESENTATION

At 10 o'clock this morning on behalf of the Board of Trade of Pittsburgh, Mayor W. C. McCharthy will present a handsome Steinway piano, valued at \$1,000, and an elegant set of colors, valued at \$500, to Capt. W. B. Donaldson. Thomas M. Marshall, Esq. will receive the presents on behalf of Capt. Donaldson.

THOUSANDS OF VISITORS

Although notice was given in yesterday's paper that the GREAT REPUBLIC would not be open to inspection until this afternoon, thousands visited her yesterday. Visitors came from the city and from all the neighboring towns, and at one time the crowd was so great that it extended half way up the wharf. The boat was crowded with a living cargo from noon to dark and hundreds were compelled to return without getting on board, contented with an outside view of her immense proportions.



VIEW FROM THE NATIONAL CEMETERY AT VICKSBURG.

Maiden Trip of the GREAT REPUBLIC

The new, magnificent and mammoth "low pressure" steamer GREAT REPUBLIC was first advertised to leave Pittsburgh on her maiden trip on Thursday March 14, 1867. This she did not do. An early spring flood crested at that place on Wednesday at 25 feet. The river was too high to get the boat under the Steubenville railroad bridge where Capt. Donaldson had learned a few lessons with

the new DICTATOR in Sept 1865 (see Dec. '65 issue pages 18-21). Departure was postponed until Saturday 16th.

Despite the purple prose lavished by skilled newsmen, the new boat at the Monongahela landing was not a vision of loveliness to the observer who saw her from the wharf. She was a smudgy jumbo with short smokestacks. Her exterior paint had been applied during unfavorable February weather in an atmosphere of coal smoke, soot and smog. The work of erecting the smokestacks was half-done because of bridge problems at Steubenville and at Cincinnati. The top portions were aboard and would not be placed until she got below Louisville.

Nonetheless the valley dwellers were determined to see the new "queen" and everybody who could hobble to the river did, and at night there were bonfires on beaches and cheering crowds. As often happens after a high stage of water, the wind turned into the North, the thermometer shrank, and the great packet got into a blizzard. The pilots rounded her to at

the foot of Brunots Island and poked her head in at McKees Rocks. The hour was late, the night dark and stormy, so they elected to stay there until daylight.

THE GREAT REPUBLIC AT MCKEES ROCKS The contemporary version of it.

About five miles below the city the engines ceased to work and our prow was turned shoreward. At once the inquiry was made "What's the matter?" In a few moments the hawser was gotten out and the REPUBLIC was laying snugly ensconced in a little cove, sheltered from the storm by the gigantic hills which towered above us. Here we were to remain all night. A trifling accident

Memphis and New Orleans.

FOR NEW ORLEANS.

THE NEW, MAGNIFICENT

AND MAMMOTH

"LOW PRESSURE"

STEAMER,

Great Republic,

W. B. DONALDSON, Commander,

WILL COMMENCE

Receiving Freight,

FOR

Memphis,

VICKSBURG,

AND

NEW ORLEANS,

ON

MONDAY, FEBRUARY 25,

AND LEAVE AS ABOVE,

ON

THURSDAY, March 14, 1867,

POSITIVELY.

—

As Passengers and Shippers will consult their interests to call on board before making engagements elsewhere. The public can rely implicitly on her leaving on above date.



INTERIOR VIEW ON OPPOSITE PAGE

The original glass plate from which this exotic picture is made came from the collection of the late Capt. Sam G. Smith of St. Louis. Cap'n Sam operated for years the "Marine Photo Co." as a side-line and made copy plates of old steamboat pictures. Very few were originals---and this is one of those few. Nobody seems to know where Cap'n Sam got this, but it ranks as one of the more impressive scenes handed down. It is the earliest known photograph showing passengers in a steamboat cabin, taken aboard the GREAT REPUBLIC. The photographer was at the stern end looking forward, in the ladies' cabin.

had occurred to one of the exhaust pipes and for this, as well as for other reasons, Capt. Donaldson concluded to lie-to until morning.

THE SHADES OF EVENING

Were fast gathering over us and for the first time we had a view of the saloon lighted up. The scene was magnificent in the extreme. The mellow light of the chandeliers threw a genial glow upon all the surroundings, and gave the vast hall with its tasteful decorations the appearance of a fairy grotto. Gay knots of belles and beaux were gathered about in the saloon, and the merry chatter and laughter that arose on all sides gave an air of ease and comfort to things within while the storm was raging with fury without.

SUPPER

About seven o'clock the saloon was fixed for supper. Ten long tables groaning with the weight of superb silverware and china extended diagonally across the space between the promenades. Servants fell into their places with all the decorum of a well regulated hotel and the guests, although with an apparent determination to be circumspect, partook of the viands with relish, their appetites made keen by the chilling but bracing air.

Through the supper hour the string band attached to the boat discoursed some of their most excellent music, and rendered the already beautiful scene delightful.

THE DANCE

Supper being over, the tables were crowded into the extremities of the saloon, and preparations were made for a dance. The musicians assembled and in a few moments the place that was occupied by the festive board was the scene of revelry and dancing. Faces beamed with the delight, and even the almost worn-out officers of the boat joined in the general merry-making. The dance was a success and was kept up until the hour of midnight, when the ladies and most of the gentlemen retired to their state-rooms.

SUNDAY MORNING

The passengers were assembled early in the cabin and in due season all were busy discussing the following bill-of-fare:

Broiled beefsteaks, plain; beefsteak with onions; calves liver; tenderloin of pork; mutton chops; spare ribs of pork, and pork chops. Fried sausage; codfish balls; hominy, onions, fish, tripe and ham. Miscellaneous: Mutton with vegetables; pork and potatoes; stewed chicken; stewed

potatoes; kidney stew, hash meats and gambillie. (Ed. Note:- Gambillie may be Yankee spelling of jambalaya which is a hash-concoction commencing with sauted sausage.) Warm bread, white rolls, cornbread, toast to order, Sallie Lunn (Ed. Note- properly Sally Lunn, a sweetened teacake served hot, usually), and cakes. Black and green tea, coffee and chocolate.

MORE ORIGINAL REPORTING

This morning about seven o'clock we cast loose from our fastenings at the "Rocks." The snow which had ceased during the night again commenced to fall, and continued to do so at intervals throughout the entire morning. There was little or no excitement. The boat passed over the many bars and shoals, occasionally touching them lightly, but without doing any damage or disturbing the general quiet of the passengers, some who loitered around and read, while others employed themselves in narrating the experiences of the past day and evening to their friends at home.

STEUBENVILLE

It being cold we were confined between decks most of the morning, but the boat running in to the shore a few miles above Steubenville, together with a momentary glimpse of Old Sol's genial face, induced a general rush to the promenade. Capt. Donaldson, being fearful that our jackstaff would not pass under the bridge, ordered a halt, and the staff was lowered. While here we were visited by a number of people from both sides of the river.

THE FIRST DINNER

Was served on board the GREAT REPUBLIC today in a most sumptuous way and what an entertainment it was, as may be readily inferred from the following bill-of-fare:-

SOUP: Macaroni, a la Italian

FISH: Baked haddock with tomato sauce

BOILED: Ham; corn beef and cabbage; sauer kraut with salt pork; tongue; leg of mutton with caper sauce; chicken.

ROASTS: Leg of lamb; beef; veal; pork, mutton; turkey, ducks, chicken, ham; with champagne sauce.

ENTREES: Minced mutton, poached eggs, char-oute rush (Ed. Note: that's what it says); fillets of chicken a la creole; pork and beans a la militaire; hogshhead; ocean sauce; ox tongue with olives; oyster pie.

VEGETABLES OF THE SEASON: Green corn, turnips mashed potatoes, sweet potatoes, green peas, beets, onions, boiled potatoes, hominy, parsnips, carrots, tomato, cabbage.

COLD DISHES: Hogshhead cheese; turkey roasted; turkey broiled; jelly.

RELISHES: Walnut catsup; cucumber pickles; John Bull sauce; chow-chow, piccalilli; French mustard; tomato catsup; Continental sauce; horseradish; Worcestershire sauce; olives, English cheese.

Pastry and Desserts

PUDDING: Fruit pudding, wine sauce

PIE AND TARTS: Blackberry, jelly tarts; peach jelly tarts; plum meringue pastry.

CAKES: Jelly cake, almond pound cake, Vienna biscuit, Genoese cake.

CREAMS AND JELLIES: Lemon jelly, anisette jelly, English cream jelly.

DESSERTS: Egg kisses, pineapple meringue

FRUITS: Apples, raisins, figs, English wal-

nuts, pecans, oranges, filberts, bananas, prunes.
COFFEE

INVOLUNTARY PASSENGERS

A ludicrous scene was enacted while the GREAT REPUBLIC was at Wheeling. The wharf was crowded with citizens who had left their homes to see the boat of which they had heard so much. As the gangway plank was run out a great crowd rushed upon the boat. Capt. Donaldson immediately rang the bell, but the multitude still poured on board the deck. When the deckers began to haul in the gangway the scene that followed is thus described in the Wheeling "Intelligencer:"

"What a rush there was, my countrymen, to get off. Whoever has seen a flock of sheep jumping over a ditch has some idea of the pell-mell style in which men and boys made their escape from the boat. Flying hats, light bamboos and all the Sunday rig got up in excellent style for the promenade on this "Queen of the Water" were all in a worse mix than a witch's kettle. The graceful attitude of the grand and lofty tumblers afforded amusement to the regular booked passengers on

the boat, and the people on shore who had sense enough to wait and see if the boat was going to remain any time at the landing. With all their hurry, some dozen persons failed to get off and this huge leviathan, unmindful of their clamor, went on her voyage. She came and was gone so quickly that one had no time to realize her vast proportions. All the boats at the landing sunk into utter insignificance, and when she was gone there seemed to be only a yawl or two tied to the shore, just that and nothing more. Considerable freight was piled up on the landing for her, but seeing the rush made to get on board her, her officers concluded to leave without it. If a little common sense had been manifested we have no doubt she would have remained at the landing an hour or so to give the people some chance of being able to form some idea of her immensity."

VISIT AT CINCINNATI

Dennis Long, the famed Louisville engine builder, and Mr. Howard, the celebrated Jeffersonville boat-builder, inspected the GREAT REPUBLIC

PASSENGER REGISTER -- STEAMER GREAT REPUBLIC -- PITTSBURGH, PA. -- MARCH 16, 1867.

These were the first passengers boarding the new boat.

Capt. and Mrs. C. W. Batchelor

Miss Anna Batchelor

See June '66 issue for portrait and biography.

William K. Nimick

Miss Lizzie Nimick

Iron and steel; the Nimicks also were stockholders in packets.

Miss Emma Floyd

Sister of G. Wash Floyd, clerk, and of Mrs. Wm. B. Donaldson. On Feb. 20, 1868 she married purser Sam Barr, Jr. with a gala wedding at New Orleans.

Mr. and Mrs. Robert McCutcheon and family
Lindsay, McCutcheon & Co., iron and steel.

Mrs. Benj. Crawford and daughter

Supervising U.S. Steamboat Inspector.

Mrs. Thomas M. Marshall and child

Top-flight Pittsburgh lawyer; Marshall Township, Allegheny County, named for him.

Stephen C. McCandless

Later director Fourth National Bank, Pgh.

Louis Dalzell

Andrew Ackley, Jr.

Wholesale meats, Pittsburgh.

W. L. Boggs, Jr.

Mr. and Mrs. Joseph P. Haigh

Misses Emma and Anna Haigh

Foundry and machine shop, Pittsburgh.

Haigh and Hartuppee were associates in the 1850's. Originally from Hancock County, W. Va. and Haigh in his reclining years lived at New Cumberland, W. Va.

Hon. and Mrs. W. R. Boggs

Messrs. Boggs & Buhl, of department store fame, Allegheny City, came from Steubenville.

Robert Mackey, Esq.

A. Tomlinson

Iron and steel, Pittsburgh.

Capt. William Hanna

Allegheny River packets.

Capt. and Mrs. Frederick G. Dippold

Towboat captain and pilot, and this was their wedding trip.

Mr. and Mrs. James H. Parker

Miss E. Zug

Iron and steel, Pittsburgh.

Charles Spang

Spang & Chalfant, iron and steel.

John A. Harper

Asst. cashier, Bank of Pittsburgh.

William C. Wall, Esq.

Artist who decorated the cabin.

Mr. and Mrs. William S. Bissell and child

Miss Rebecca Shields

Miss Hannah Shields

Miss Mary Bissell

These were kinfolk; the Shields girls were daughters of David Shields for whom Dashields Locks and Dam is named.

Dr. Gazzum

Pittsburgh physician.

J. Lowry, Jr.

W. S. Haven, Esq.

Printer and bookbinder, Pittsburgh.

Charles Gearing, Esq.

Steamboat cabin builder, Pittsburgh.

G. W. Coffin

Lumber and turnings.

James B. Oliver

Iron and steel, Pittsburgh.

C. G. Donnell

Mr. and Mrs. Andrew Hartuppee

Miss Ida Hartuppee

Miss Flora Hartuppee

Master Willie Hartuppee

Steamboat engine builder, Pittsburgh.

John McClanahan

Reporter, New York Herald.

William M. Runkel

Reporter, Pittsburgh Commercial.

at Cincinnati and judged her a great success in every particular. Between 25 and 30,000 people visited the GREAT REPUBLIC here. She lies at the foot of Race Street (Ed. NOTE: Below the suspension bridge.) She will leave today at noon (Thursday, March 21.) Capt. Donaldson has received a telegram from Capt. Pink Varble saying there would be water on the Falls tomorrow for the 'steam mastadon', and advised him to take all the freight he could get.

ARRIVAL AT LOUISVILLE

Louisville, March 22, 1867: Special correspondence to the Pittsburgh "Commercial:" This morning between the hours of 9 and 10 a.m. the beautiful and mammoth GREAT REPUBLIC sailed into this port. She came up to the expectations of all those who felt interested in her, and astonished a great many who were indignant at the name and place where she was built. She lay a short distance above the U. S. Mail Line wharfboat and crowds flocked down to see her. She only remained about three-quarters of an hour, when she left for Portland, Ky. where she will lay over until tomorrow.

OPINIONS AT LOUISVILLE

Reported in the Louisville "Democrat:" We did not hear anyone say they liked the outside appearance of the GREAT REPUBLIC. She went over the Falls drawing $8\frac{1}{2}$ feet of water. She is a fine boat and we are of the opinion that \$375,000 ought to make anything fine. Her general outside appearance will not favorably impress a stranger that she is anything extra.

Reported the Louisville "Courier:" The new boat lacks symmetry and liveness and is too wide and heavy for real usefulness on our waters. She will only be able to run in deep water, as the draught line is conceded to be $4\frac{1}{2}$ feet; of course with fuel, etc. on, she will certainly draw 5 ft. of water. The cabin of the boat is the most attractive feature, the skill and experience of a former Louisville builder, Charles Gearing. When once on board and under arch and canopy of the cabin, all the real beauty of the boat stands revealed. The style is an improvement on the first MAYFLOWER, and next to the RUTH, though very similar in design. As usual in all 'upper-country' boats, a vast deal of labor and expense has been incurred in outside show: 'gew-gaws,' tinsel,

BUILDING THE HULL FOR THE GREAT REPUBLIC -- SOMETHING ABOUT SHOUSETOWN, PA.

Shousetown, Pa. is not on the 1967 maps as the town was renamed years ago and today is Glenwillard. There, on the left bank of the Ohio River at Mile 13.8 below Pittsburgh, soon after tows leave Dashields Locks downbound, is the site of the famed boat yard where the GREAT REPUBLIC's hull was built. There is no sign of the old yard now; nor has there been boat construction there for about 90 years.

Shousetown was named for a German flatboat and hull builder, Peter Shouse, who started his career along the Monongahela; then he moved bag-&-baggage to found the hamlet bearing his name. He had nothing to do with building the GREAT REPUBLIC nor, for that matter, with most of the steamers built there. He was 79 when the REPUBLIC was launched and died about five years later.

When Shousetown originally was laid out (1822) Peter Shouse brought along a helpmate 13 years his junior, Ezra Porter, who was also at the Monongahela yard and who (circa 1827) married Peter Shouse's daughter Elizabeth aged 16. Ezra's younger brother (by seven years) Nathan Porter was a river steamboat engineer but he came ashore to marry one of the Anderson girls who lived just opposite Shousetown in a riverbank brick house, and thenceforth the Shousetown boat yard was run by E. & N. Porter. Peter Shouse often went on extended trips to the "Indian country" and gave the boat yard no more heed.

Ezra and Elizabeth Porter raised a considerable family. Son Joe went on the river; son Elias went to W&J and became a country doctor; son Bob was probably the black sheep, noted in the neighborhood for gambling; but son Nathan Jr. (named for his uncle and the Jr. tacked on to separate the two) was the upstanding youngster who became a talented marine draughtsman and laid down the lines in the loft for most of the famed steamboats Shousetown produced, the GREAT REPUBLIC included.

Much of the timber used in building the GREAT REPUBLIC was cut on the hillsides back of town, and this single contract just about ended the local supply of trees. Nate Porter Jr. and boss carpenter John C. Boggs had to go deep into the West Virginia hills bordering the upper Monongahela to cut oak for the lengthy cylinder timbers. Boggs was an old-timer in the region; his grandpa Andrew Boggs until he died (1843) ran Lashell's ferry at Sewickley.

The hull price for the GREAT REPUBLIC was \$50,700, the biggest contract the Porter boys had ever landed, or ever would. The Custom House measurements of it were 328 x 50 x 10, rated 1727.12 tons. The hulls at Shousetown were built on a slope headed downriver; and were launched "end on" as the expression was, stern-first. The launching date for the GREAT REPUBLIC was on Saturday, November 3, 1866. The word had spread and natives came by horseback, buggy and on shanksmare to line both sides of the river. Your S&D REFLECTOR editor's grandmother Mrs. P. D. Nicols was one of the spectators. We have her word for it that the hull broke fetters somewhat premature of plans, gathered great speed, created an even greater splash and, having no moorings, sailed across the Ohio to bury the stern in the river mud. A towboat had to be called in to release it. Rumor soon got abroad that a workman at the boat yard had been killed in the affair, and the old hands of the region tell this as gospel even today--so it well may be so. In any event, the Ohio River was at a relatively low stage when the launch was made (7'6" at Pittsburgh and falling) and so the hull had a lengthy distance to travel before striking the water, and consequently was propelled at more than usual speed, both because of distance and weight. It was found on inspection to be warped or "hogged" and large piles of coal were placed in it, amidships, to flatten it back to shape. In this situation, it was towed up to Pittsburgh (Nov. 7, 1866) for completion.

paint and trimming. The staterooms are far inferior to expectations.

Reported the Louisville "Journal:" Capt. Pink Varble took the new boat over the Falls in fine style. She handles very well, in fact much better than from her clumsy appearance any one would suppose. From the fact that only half of her chimneys were raised to allow her to pass under the bridge at Cincinnati, her appearance at the best, clumsy and unsymmetrical, was anything but prepossessing. She seemed to be too long in front of her wheelhouses, and too short behind them. Her Texas is not well proportioned to her cabin, and her pilothouse is an absurd cross between an ornamented grape arbor and a fancy hen house. The general impression of the boat, as a whole, from the bank, is an unfavorable one. But as we ascend the stairs and enter the cabin we are enchanted with the lightness and airy grace. It is an imitation to some extent of the cabins of the Hudson River packets, the finest in the world. We had the pleasure of the company of Harry M. Miller of the Cincinnati "Commercial," who was kind enough to show us every point of interest. We also saw J. H. McCoellehan of the New York "Herald," and W. M. Runkle of the Pittsburgh "Commercial."

COMMENTS AT NEW ALBANY

Reported the New Albany "Register:" The GREAT REPUBLIC looked like a huge ark as she rounded the point. This great steamer which has been the theme of river editors for the past six or eight months arrived this morning (Friday, March 22). We went on board and were shown through her by Harry M. Miller of the Cincinnati "Commercial." Her cabin is certainly the most magnificent piece of work turned out on the Western Waters. It is constructed after the style of the North River steamer DEAN RICHMOND. The furniture is of the most elaborate and costly finish, corresponding in every particular with the surroundings. While the inside view is most elegant, we cannot say as much for her outside appearance. It looks heavy, cramped, and decidedly rough. Any steamboatman could tell at a glance she was built at Pittsburgh.

Later:- The GREAT REPUBLIC has her chimneys up and will leave positively this evening (Monday, March 25) for New Orleans. She has been thronged with visitors since laying at Portland. The street cars between there and Louisville have been taxed to capacity. New Albanians by the thousands visited her Saturday and yesterday and she is still jammed full of admiring spectators.

Reported the New Albany "Ledger:" The exterior outside appearance is not very prepossessing. She looks unweildy, and her outside painting is about the poorest job of work we ever saw. She is weather-stained and smoke-begrimed. She will prove a popular passenger steamer, and in regard to her accommodations and furnishings she will probably have no rival. Both new boats, the RICHMOND and the GREAT REPUBLIC, will be monuments to the enterprise and good taste of their builders. There is plenty of business for both, and there is therefor no cause for ill-feeling in the way of rivalry. Neither of them will be able to beat the famous New Albany-built steamer ROBT. E. LEE.

PHOTOGRAPHS TAKEN

The Louisville "Courier" says they have had a

fine photograph taken of the GREAT REPUBLIC, an exact living picture, and invited any of their friends who want a copy to apply for it. (Ed. Note:- This picture apparently has been lost, as no copy is known to exist).

OPINION AT EVANSVILLE

Col. Silverthorn, reporter for the Evansville "Journal" has this to say: Standing on the roof of Dunkerson & Company's mammoth wharffboat, we watched the GREAT REPUBLIC land here, so easily and gently that she scarcely caused a jar. Her exterior design is new, and it takes time to fully comprehend it. A carping hypocrite might find fault, but the candid admirer of real beauty will only note her perfections. The crowd of people who visited her while here was immense; men, women and children flocked in countless thousands, wading through mud and pelting rain. She was crowded as long as she lay here. Some stood in her cabin for hours, gazing and wondering. Among her passengers we were delighted to see Capt. C. W. Batchelor of Pittsburgh, who, with his family, are aboard. She took a large amount of freight here and left at five o'clock (Monday, March 25). Her guards were down to the water when she left.

CAIRO CARPINGS

There is one defect in the cabin of the new boat which we will note for the benefit of the Louisville papers who have almost strained themselves to death in endeavor to find fault with her, and have succeeded but moderately. The defect, or oversight, consists in having placed these landscapes and water scenes so high up that persons are compelled to assume a rather ungraceful attitude in viewing them. There is scarcely more than one man in ten who can throw back his head far enough to take a good look at them but who is compelled in doing so to open his mouth. Now, I submit it to the Louisville astute critics if this is not the most ungraceful attitude for gentlemen and "perfectly awful" for ladies. I was once so unfortunate so as to be born in Pittsburgh, but I solemnly promise the Louisville papers I shall never do so again. I claim Louisville gratitude for having pointed out one more defect in the GREAT REPUBLIC, and hope now that all the world will agree with them that "Nothing good can come out of Pittsburgh." Capt. Donaldson has engaged 100 tons of freight at Memphis as there is very little here. Her machinery is entirely blocked off and hidden by enormous piles of sacked corn; all other portions of her lower decks and hold are apparently well filled.

ARRIVAL AT MEMPHIS

Reported in the Memphis "Post:" The GREAT REPUBLIC arrived here yesterday (Friday, March 29) in all her glory. The moment she came in sight, opposite the bend, a grand rush for the bluff and levee commenced and by the time the boat reached the wharf hundreds of people were swarming along the levee impatient to board the palatial craft. During the five hours while she lay here she was crowded with admiring spectators superlative in praise. In a word she is a floating exposition of modern improvements in river architecture and machinery, and is the means of contributing to the comfort and pleasure of all who wish to travel on the Mississippi River. The GREAT EASTERN has formerly been the world's proudest boast in marine enterprises, but hereafter we shall be equally proud of the GREAT RE-

PUBLIC.

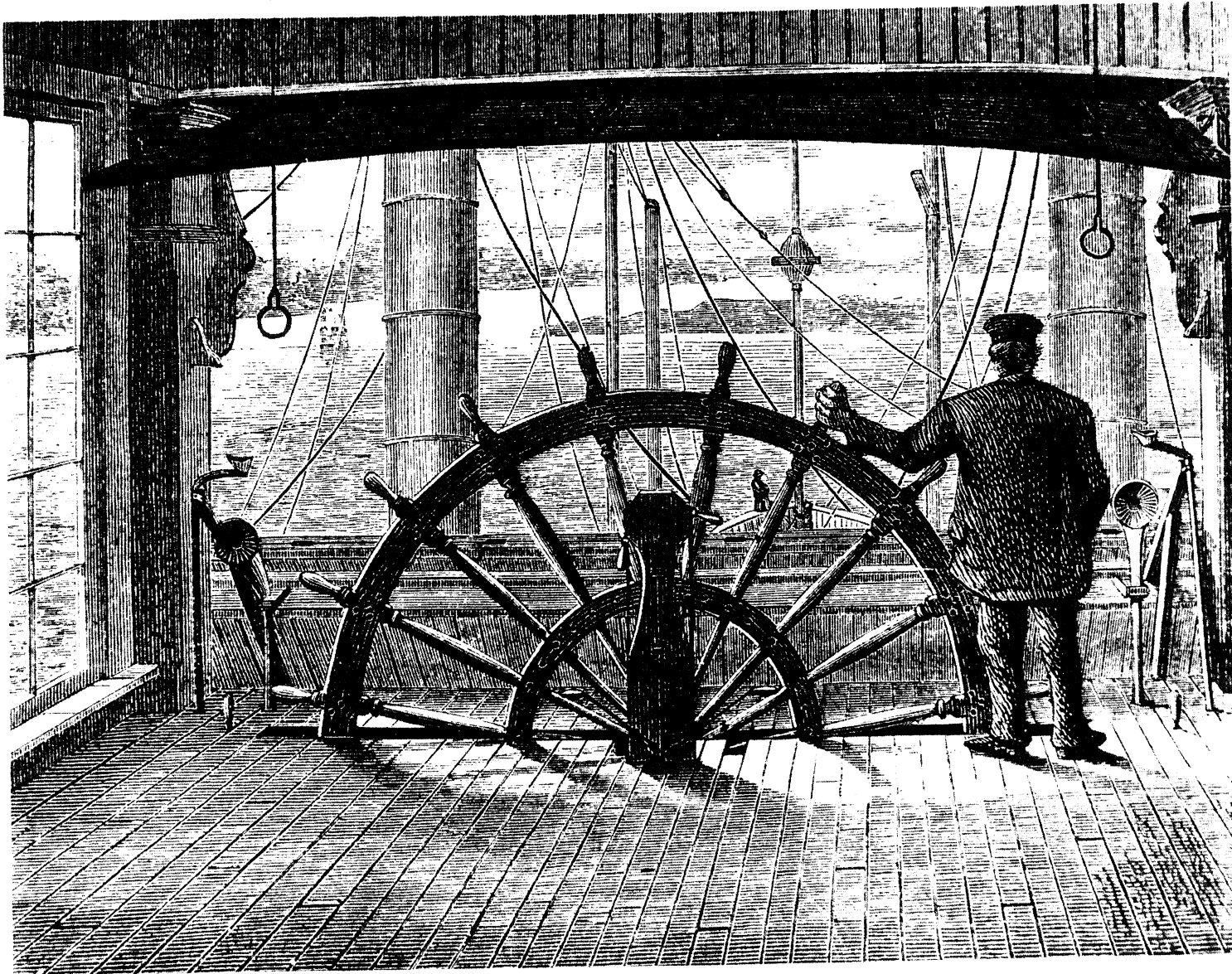
THE GREAT REPUBLIC AT NEW ORLEANS

Reported in the New Orleans "Bulletin:" That gorgeous palace arrived early yesterday morning (undated) under a cargo comprising some 2300 tons of freight and a cabin crowded with passengers. Stepping on board soon after her arrival, it was our good pleasure to meet her urbane commander, Capt. W. B. Donaldson, who, though busily engaged in answering the various questions propounded to him, found time to show us through and explain the beauties of his palatial steamer. Such a boat as the GREAT REPUBLIC has never before made fast to our landing. She stands without a peer.

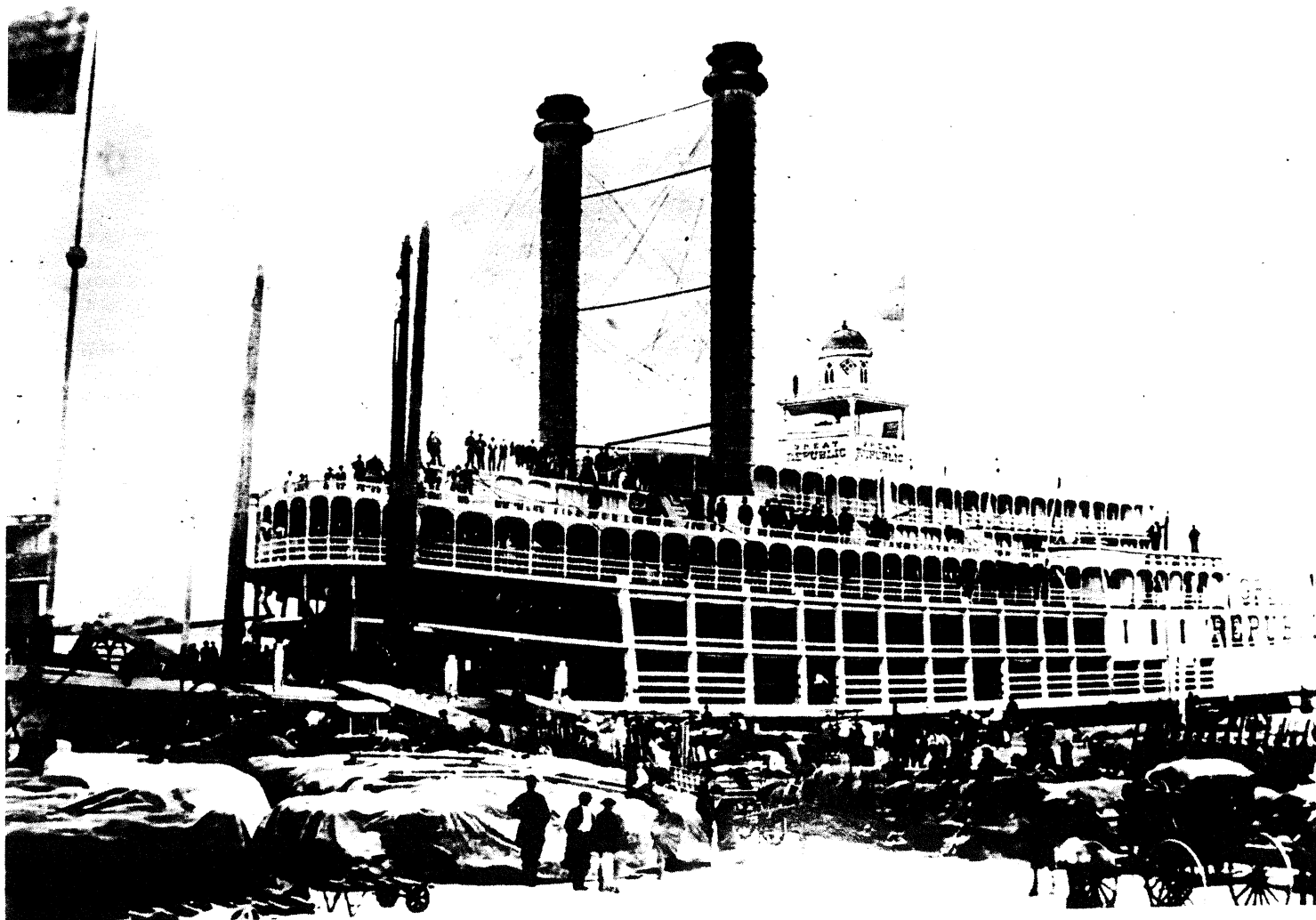
Reported in the New Orleans "Crescent:" The great event of the day and of the Age was the arrival of the mammoth, far-famed and long expected palatial steamer GREAT REPUBLIC from Pittsburgh, which boat reached our city yesterday morning loaded to the guards with produce, and her cabin crowded with passengers. The telegram which we published on Monday afternoon (Monday, April 1), giving notice that she had passed Vicksburg, caused numbers to linger on the levee to a late

hour in the night in hopes of being first to board her, but they were compelled to retire, disappointed. Again yesterday morning the levee was crowded at an early hour with a large concourse, expecting that she would be at the landing; but it was after sunrise before she hove in sight around the point. The immense crowd in waiting was thrown into a high state of excitement. No sooner had her gangplank been shoved out to shore than her cabins were besieged with those anxious to inspect her; and during the whole day multitudes of our citizens were wending their way to this floating palace and examining her in every detail which was accessible.

Reported in the New Orleans "Times:" From early dawn to dewy eve, visitors continued to pour aboard the GREAT REPUBLIC, literally taking the boat by storm. The carpet suffered, but the boat itself made an impression never to be forgotten. We noticed going aboard many of the fair sex. The new boat is lying at the foot of Poydras Street, and those who did not see her yesterday should do so today, as she leaves for St. Louis tomorrow evening at 5 o'clock.



PILOTHOUSE INTERIOR OF THE GREAT REPUBLIC. -Front page picture and this one from the October, 1874 issue of Scribner's Monthly, illustrating an article, "The Great South."



WAS THIS PHOTOGRAPH MADE AT NEW ORLEANS ON THE OCCASION OF THE GREAT REPUBLIC'S FIRST TRIP? It may be. It may not be. No accounts examined so far state whether or not the fancy-top feathers (seen on our front page engraving) were placed when the stacks were first raised. She had 'em--but maybe later. - Above picture from the Capt. Sam G. Smith collection.

Later news from the New Orleans "Times:" Large crowds were on hand at the landing to see the GREAT REPUBLIC off (evening of April 4) and when approaching the hour of 5 o'clock, every available spot and freight pile was occupied. When 5 o'clock came it was discovered by the engineer that one of her heaters was out of order and had to be attended to, which necessarily detained the boat until after dark.

Said the New Orleans "Crescent." A storm prevailed as the GREAT REPUBLIC was due to depart but at dark she still quietly 'smoked' at the levee, detained by an accident to her 'doctor.' The water-proofs and stout overcoats generally worn by the New Orleans visitors aboard were contrasted very ludicrously with the white pants and straw hats donned yesterday by our Northern visitors in some fatal dream of the tropical softness of the "Sunny South." There was a pleasant omen connected with the delay: At the

hour when she was expected to depart the skies were dark, threatening and rent with frequent flashes of lightning. An hour later the strong yellow beams of the setting sun burst from the confining mists, and while flooding the western sky with mellow radiance, poured a great stream of light upon Poydras Street which lit up the huge mass of the GREAT REPUBLIC until it shone like a "glory." The next instant and a beautiful rainbow spanned the sky directly over the steamer. It was altogether a picturesque and charming spectacle, and we trust an omen of prosperity not less so to the steamer GREAT REPUBLIC than to its great namesake, in which boat we must all "sink or swim," "live or die," survive or perish.



